Import data using transform maps(spreadsheet)

Introduction:

Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet) is a commonly used feature in ServiceNow to import large amounts of data from external sources such as Excel or CSV spreadsheets into ServiceNow tables.

It helps organizations transfer data efficiently without entering each record manually.
In this process, the spreadsheet data is first uploaded into an Import Set Table.

A Transform Map is then created to define how the imported data should be mapped to the fields of the target ServiceNow table. Field mapping ensures that each column in the spreadsheet is placed into the correct field in the target table.

Objectives:

To import data efficiently from Excel or CSV spreadsheets into ServiceNow.

To reduce manual data entry and save time when handling large amounts of information.

To understand Import Sets and learn how external spreadsheet data is temporarily stored before transformation.

To create and configure Transform Maps for transferring data from an Import Set table to a target ServiceNow table.

To map spreadsheet columns to the appropriate fields in the target table.

To create new records in ServiceNow using data from the spreadsheet.

To update existing records based on matching or coalesce fields.

To maintain data accuracy and consistency during the import process.

To identify and handle duplicate records using appropriate field mapping and coalesce options.

To validate the imported data and ensure that all records are correctly transferred to the target table.

To understand transformation rules and scripts that can modify data during the import process.

To improve data migration and integration processes by providing a systematic method for importing external data into ServiceNow.

Requirements:

1. ServiceNow Instance

A working ServiceNow instance is required.
The user should have appropriate permissions to access Import Sets and Transform Maps.

2. Spreadsheet File
An Excel (.xlsx) or CSV (.csv) file containing the data to be imported.
The spreadsheet should have properly organized column headings.
Data should be clean and consistent to avoid import errors.

3. Source Data
The spreadsheet should contain relevant information such as:
Name
Email
Department
Location
Employee ID
Other required fields depending on the target table.

4. Import Set Table
An Import Set Table is required to temporarily store the spreadsheet data.
The imported columns should be available as fields in the Import Set Table.

5. Target Table
A ServiceNow target table must be selected where the transformed data will be stored.
Example: Incident, User, Asset, or Configuration Item (CI) table.

6. Transform Map
A Transform Map must be created between the Import Set Table and the target table.
It defines how source fields are transferred to target fields.

7. Field Mapping
Source spreadsheet columns must be mapped to the corresponding target table fields.
Appropriate field mappings should be configured to ensure accurate data transfer.

8. Coalesce Field
A suitable coalesce field can be configured to identify existing records.
This helps determine whether the imported data should create a new record or update an existing record.

9. Data Validation

The imported data should be checked for missing values, incorrect formats, duplicate records, and invalid information.
Import logs should be reviewed after the transformation.

10. Testing sample spreadsheet should be tested before importing the complete dataset.

Implementation Steps

Step 1: Prepare the Spreadsheet
Create an Excel or CSV file containing the required data. Make sure the first row contains clear column names.

Step 2: Log in to ServiceNow
Open the ServiceNow instance.
Log in using valid credentials.
Navigate to All → System Import Sets → Load Data.

Step 3: Upload the Spreadsheet
Select Load Data.
Choose the prepared Excel/CSV file.
Select the appropriate file format.
Select Create table or an existing Import Set Table.
Click Submit.

Step 4: Verify the Import Set Table
Open the generated Import Set Table and verify that:
All spreadsheet columns are available.
Records have been imported correctly.
Data is displayed without formatting or conversion errors.

Step 5: Create a Transform Map
Navigate to System Import Sets → Transform Maps.
Click New.
Enter a suitable Name.
Select the Source table (Import Set Table).
Select the required Target table.
Save the Transform Map.

Step 6: Configure Field Mappings
Open the Transform Map and configure Field Maps.
Map each source field to its corresponding target field.

Step 7: Configure Coalesce
Select a unique field, such as Employee ID, as the Coalesce field.

This allows ServiceNow to determine whether an imported record should:
Create a new record, or
Update an existing record.

Step 8: Run the Transform
Return to the Import Set.
Select the uploaded data.
Click Transform.
Select the required Transform Map.
Start the transformation.

Step 9: Check Import Logs
After transformation, review the Import Set and Transform logs.
Check for:
Successful records
Failed records
Mapping errors
Data validation errors
Updated records.

Step 10: Verify the Target Table
Open the target table and verify that the imported records are present.
Check that:
Data is stored in the correct fields.
New records were created correctly.
Existing records were updated where applicable.
No unexpected duplicate records were created.

Process Flow:

Spreadsheet → Load Data → Import Set Table → Transform Map → Field Mapping → Transform → Target Table

Testing:

The Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet) functionality was tested to verify that spreadsheet data was correctly imported and transformed into the target ServiceNow table.

Result:

The Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet) process was successfully implemented in ServiceNow. The spreadsheet data was uploaded into an Import Set Table, and a Transform Map was configured to transfer the data to the required target table.

The source fields were mapped correctly to the corresponding target fields, and the transformation was executed successfully. The imported records were verified in the target table, and the data was found to be accurate and properly organized.

Conclusion:

The project successfully demonstrated how spreadsheet data can be imported into ServiceNow using Import Sets and Transform Maps, reducing manual data entry and improving data migration efficiency.